

SOC Analyst Incident Investigation Report Template

1. Incident Information

Incident ID: IR-2026-001

Date/Time Detected: Jun 20th, 2026 @ 14:46:01.315

Analyst: Clinton Etienne

Alert Source: Wazuh SIEM

Severity: medium. Rule level 8

Affected Host(s): Ubuntu-target (192.168.56.107)

2. Executive Summary

Rule ID 5901 was generated in Wazuh SIEM after detecting the creation of a new local group on the Ubuntu_target endpoint (192.168.56.107). The event originated from the adduser process and was recorded through the system journal. The investigation determined that the activity was performed by an authorized administrator. No evidence of unauthorized access or malicious activity was identified.

3. Alert Details

Rule Name: New group added to system.

Alert Description: new user group, user, and password created.

Source IP:192.168.56.107

Destination IP:192.168.56.107

Username/Account:Clinton

MITRE ATT&CK Technique: Defense Evasion, Privilege Escalation, Persistence, Initial Access.

4. Timeline of Events

1. user authenticated to Ubuntu_target.
2. First-time sudo usage detected.
3. Successful privilege escalation to root.
4. New user account created.
5. New group created automatically for the account.
6. Password assigned to account.

7, Wazuh generated Rule 5901 alert.

5. Investigation Findings

A review of related Wazuh alerts confirmed that the activity was performed by an authorized administrator during normal business hours. No malicious behavior, persistence mechanisms, or unauthorized access attempts were identified.

6. Evidence

🔍

🔍

📄

Jun 20 19:46:00 ubuntu-target sudo[14617]: clinton : TTY=/dev/pts/0
PWD=/home/clinton ; USER=root ; COMMAND=/usr/sbin/useradd testuser1

🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:23.431	Ubuntu-target	🔍	🔍	PAM: Login session closed.	3	5502
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:23.427	Ubuntu-target			PAM: User changed password.	3	5555
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:13.412	Ubuntu-target			Successful sudo to ROOT executed.	3	5402
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:13.398	Ubuntu-target			PAM: Login session opened.	3	5501
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:01.320	Ubuntu-target			PAM: Login session closed.	3	5502
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:01.319	Ubuntu-target			New user added to the system.	8	5902
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:01.315	Ubuntu-target			New group added to the system.	8	5901
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:01.306	Ubuntu-target			First time user executed sudo.	4	5403
🔍	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:01.303	Ubuntu-target			PAM: Login session opened.	3	5501

🔍

🔍

📄

🔍	rule.groups	syslog, adduser
🔍	rule.hipaa	164.312.b, 164.312.a.2.I, 164.312.a.2.II
🔍	rule.id	5901
#	rule.level	8
🔍	rule.mail	false
🔍	rule.nist_800_53	AU.14, AC.7, AC.2, IA.4
🔍	rule.pci_dss	10.2.7, 10.2.5, 8.1.2
🔍	rule.tsc	CC6.8, CC7.2, CC7.3
📅	timestamp	Jun 20, 2026 @ 14:46:01.315

7. Impact Assessment

No adverse impact. Activity was performed by an authorized administrator user.

8. Containment and Remediation

No actions taken.

9. Lessons Learned

The authorized administrator account was accessed on the first login attempt. User group, user, and password were then added. This follows typical administrative duties and raises no red flags.

10. Skills Demonstrated

SIEM Analysis, Log Correlation, Incident Response, etc.

11. Final Disposition

True Positive / False Positive

Closed Date: June 20th, 2026. 3:45pm.

Analyst Signature: Clinton Etienne